SOCIOCULTURAL FALSE BELIEF #42 · MENTAL HEALTH AND SEEKING HELP

“Needing counseling means I have weak faith.”

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Where it often comes from

Some were taught that prayer and Bible reading should be enough, and that anxiety or sadness shows a lack of trust. Seeking a counselor then feels like admitting spiritual failure. Many suffer for years before asking for help.

What Scripture teaches

Jesus said, “It is not the healthy who need a doctor, but the sick.” Scripture honors counsel: “Plans fail for lack of counsel, but with many advisers they succeed,” and “The way of a fool is right in his own eyes, but a wise man listens to counsel.” Paul writes, “Carry one another’s burdens, and in this way you will fulfill the law of Christ.” “He heals the brokenhearted and binds up their wounds.” God often heals through people. Asking for help is an act of wisdom and humility, and often of faith.

> *“Plans fail for lack of counsel, but with many advisers they succeed”* (Proverbs 15:22).

Also see

> “Jesus answered, ‘It is not the healthy who need a doctor, but the sick.’” (Luke 5:31).

> “The way of a fool is right in his own eyes, but a wise man listens to counsel” (Proverbs 12:15).

> “Carry one another’s burdens, and in this way you will fulfill the law of Christ” (Galatians 6:2).

> “He heals the brokenhearted and binds up their wounds” (Psalm 147:3).

Common self-statements

- If I trusted God more, I would not need help.
- Counseling is for people without faith.
- I should handle this through prayer alone.
- Going means I failed spiritually.
- People will think my faith is weak.
- God should be enough.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing I must choose either faith or counseling.
- Mind reading: Assuming others will judge my faith.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling ashamed and concluding that I have failed.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that counseling would not fit my faith.

Challenging questions

- Where did I learn that counseling means weak faith?
- Would I say that of someone who sees a doctor for an infection?
- What does Scripture say about seeking counsel?
- What has trying alone cost me?
- What would a Christian counselor offer?

- What is one step toward getting help?

Truth summary

> Seeking counsel is wise and consistent with faith. God works through prayer, Scripture, and also through trained, caring people. Asking for help is a step of courage, not weakness.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Therapy
- Wisdom
- Humility
- Pride
- Depression, Symptoms of

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Divorce
- Addictions

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Praise You in This Storm — Casting Crowns featuring Phil Wickham
Suffering and tears do not establish that God is absent or uncaring.

Living Hope — Phil Wickham
Christ's resurrection and forgiveness provide hope beyond sin and death.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "Needing counseling means I have weak faith"

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"Needing counseling means I have weak faith." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Where did I learn this?
- ☐ Would I say it of a doctor visit?
- ☐ What does Scripture say about counsel?
- ☐ What has trying alone cost?
- ☐ What could a counselor offer?
- ☐ What is my next step?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ The sick need a doctor.
- ☐ Plans succeed with many advisers.
- ☐ A wise man listens to counsel.
- ☐ We carry one another's burdens.
- ☐ God heals through people too.
- ☐ Asking for help is wisdom.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Proverbs 15:22
  "Plans fail for lack of counsel, but with many advisers they succeed."
- ☐ Luke 5:31
  "Jesus answered, 'It is not the healthy who need a doctor, but the sick.'"
- ☐ Galatians 6:2
  "Carry one another's burdens, and in this way you will fulfill the law of Christ."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] One step toward help: Each week, note one step you took toward support.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Proverbs 15:22 becomes: "Sarah can write: "Plans succeed with many advisers, so seeking counsel is wise.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Therapy" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If there is violence, coercion, or fear of retaliation, seek private professional support before trying anything with the other person. In an emergency call 911.

- [ ] Write the barrier. List what holds you back.
- [ ] Talk with someone. Share with a pastor or trusted friend.
- [ ] Find a counselor. Look for a licensed Christian counselor.
- [ ] Pray Proverbs 15:22. Ask God to guide you.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "Needing counseling means I have weak faith": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	One step toward help
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~Needing counseling means I have weak faith.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Father, I thought needing help meant weak faith. Thank You for giving us counselors and friends. Give me courage to ask and wisdom to choose well. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.